

# COMMAND — Dashboards and Reports

Our answers to the eight points from the call on 29 August 2026. Every number here was measured on your own instance (dev390988) on 30 August 2026.

## Quick summary

| What you asked                           | Status                            | Our answer                                                                                                            |
|------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1. Show only reports that are "active"   | We need your answer               | There are two different "active" settings. The one in your screenshot is not safe to filter on. We explain why below. |
| 2. Change the chart type for a report    | Already built                     | Every chart has a button to change its type. It also explains why each type was picked.                               |
| 3. Does this follow ServiceNow UI rules? | Yes                               | Your own UI rules allow this. Explained on page 1.                                                                    |
| 4. Drill down 2 levels is fine           | We built 3                        | You can click down 3 levels. Tested again on 30 August.                                                               |
| 5. Architecture and data flow diagram    | Included                          | See the diagram on page 2.                                                                                            |
| 6a. Where are converted reports saved?   | Nowhere                           | We never save a copy. See page 2.                                                                                     |
| 6b. The loading skeleton — free or paid? | Built. Free.                      | Thank you for the clarification. We built it. It costs nothing. See page 2.                                           |
| 7. Many users at once, and speed         | Measured, and not yet good enough | Real numbers on page 2, plus a clear list of what we have not yet tested.                                             |
| 8. Happy with the design                 | Noted                             | Thank you. Nothing to do here.                                                                                        |

## 1. The "active" question

The screenshot you showed us was ServiceNow's list of report *settings*. It was not a list of the data inside those reports. This is an important difference.

We checked your instance. You have **682 saved reports. Only 2 are marked Active = true. The other 680 are marked Active = false.** But those 680 reports are good reports that people use. For example, "My Groups Work" and "Business Services by Location" are both marked false.

**So if we hid every report marked false, your report list would drop from 682 reports to only 2.** That would hide almost everything. This is why we checked first and did not build it.

**We think you meant something different, and that thing is real.** Your incident, problem, and change tables each have their own "active" field on the records themselves. Right now, when you open one of these, COMMAND shows both open and closed records together.

**What we suggest:** when you open a table, show only the active (open) records by default. Anyone who wants to see closed records can click one filter to see them. This is a small change and quick to build. We are waiting for your answer first, because it changes what everyone sees by default.

## 2. Changing the chart type

This is already built and working. Every chart on the page has a "Chart" button. When you click it, you will see:

- Which chart type is being used right now, and why we picked it.
- Every other chart type that will work with this data, and why each one would work.
- Chart types we did *not* offer, and the reason why. For example, a pie chart is not offered when there are too many categories to read.

When you pick a different chart type, the page address changes. So you can copy that link and send it to someone. They will see the same chart you chose.

### 3. Does this follow the ServiceNow UI rules?

Yes. Your UI standards document says to use standard ServiceNow components, **except when a business need cannot be met by them**. That exception is written in your own document.

You asked for dashboards that look like Power BI. The standard ServiceNow chart tools cannot do that. So we use the exception. We build custom charts, but we style them using ServiceNow's own colours, fonts, and spacing. The result looks like it belongs in ServiceNow. We also write down every place we did something custom, and the reason, as your document asks.

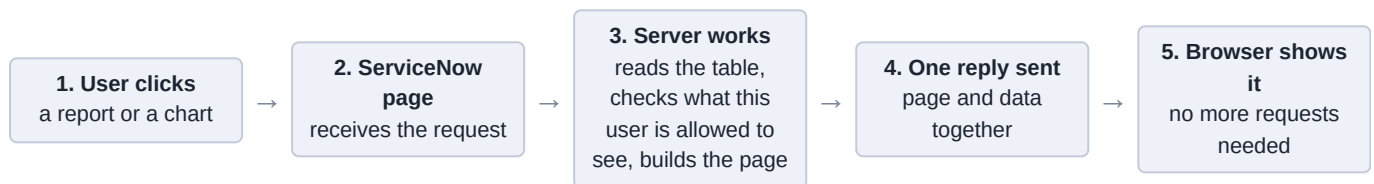
### 4. Drill down

You said 2 levels would be enough. **We built 3 levels.**

We also stop it at 3 on purpose, and we check this in two separate places on the server. This means nobody can change the web address by hand to go deeper than 3. We tested this again on 30 August. We sent a fake address asking for 5 levels. The system correctly cut it back to 3, showed the right filters on screen, and gave no error.

### 5. Architecture and data flow

Everything happens in one round trip inside ServiceNow. Nothing runs in the background and nothing is sent outside:



*No outside website or service is ever contacted. No record ever leaves your instance. Because everything is built in step 3, the speed numbers in point 7 below behave the way they do.*

#### 6a. Where are converted reports saved?

**We do not save them anywhere.**

When you open a report, we read that report's settings from ServiceNow at that moment, build the page, and then forget it. There is no copy stored anywhere.

This has a useful result for you. If you edit a report's filter in ServiceNow's own report builder and save it, then open the same report in COMMAND, your change is already there. There is no second copy that can become out of date.

#### 6b. The loading skeleton

Thank you for the clarification: **"Report design outcome skeleton"**. This is the grey placeholder layout that appears while a page is loading. Power BI and similar tools show this too.

There was one technical problem to solve. COMMAND builds the whole page on the server and sends it in one piece. So there is no moment during loading where we can show something on the new page. Our solution: we show the skeleton on the page you are *leaving*, the moment you click. It appears instantly, then the real page replaces it.

**Now working on every link inside COMMAND:** report cards, saved reports, drill down clicks, chart type changes, search, and page numbers. The shape of the skeleton matches the page you are going to. Links that leave COMMAND and go to a normal ServiceNow page are left alone on purpose.

**Cost: free.** We used plain CSS and JavaScript that we wrote ourselves. There is no paid library and no licence to buy.

### 7. Many users at once, and speed

You asked what happens with 100,000+ reports and many people using it at the same time. We want to be careful and exact here, so we have separated what we **measured** from what we have **not yet measured**.

#### What we measured

We opened the same page many times at the exact same moment on your development instance:

| Page                    | 1 user   | 4 users at once | 8 users at once | 16 users at once | Failures |
|-------------------------|----------|-----------------|-----------------|------------------|----------|
| Incident dashboard      | 10.5 sec | 16.2 sec        | 28.0 sec        | 40.6 sec         | None     |
| Report list (home page) | 6.7 sec  | 11.9 sec        | 19.6 sec        | not tested       | None     |

Nothing failed at any level, and no user received another user's data. But **these times are slow, and we are not going to present them as acceptable**. They get worse as more people use it, and that is a real finding, not a testing artefact.

### Why it slows down — the honest reason

COMMAND does not reuse any result. If 10 people open the same dashboard in the same minute, the server does the same work 10 separate times from the beginning.

This is a deliberate trade we made in favour of security. Reusing a result between users is exactly how one user can accidentally be shown another user's numbers. We chose correctness first. But it does mean the product is not yet ready for a large number of simultaneous users, and we are telling you that directly.

### What we have NOT measured — please read this

- **We have not tested with 100,000 reports.** Your instance has 682. What we fixed and verified is the *mechanism*: searching and paging now happen on the server, so the product no longer has the 300-report ceiling it used to have. We have good reason to expect this scales, but we have not proven it at 100,000 and we will not claim we have.
- **We have not tested on production hardware.** These numbers come from a shared development instance that runs its own background jobs. Production will very likely be faster. We cannot tell you by how much, so please do not treat these seconds as a production estimate in either direction.
- **We have not tested beyond 16 simultaneous users.**

### What we recommend

Before any rollout to a large group, we recommend two pieces of work: **(1)** build a short-term cache so repeated work is reused safely, per user, without mixing data between users, and **(2)** run a proper load test on a production-sized instance with a realistic number of reports. We would rather do this properly than give you a number we cannot stand behind.

## Security: the region and role question

You asked whether a user in India sees only their own region's data, or everything simply because they can open the page. This is the right question to ask, so we want to answer it carefully and show exactly what we tested.

### How access is decided (the important part)

COMMAND does not decide what you can see by checking your role name, and it does not trust a simple record count. For every user, on every page load, it **actually attempts to read the real records using that user's own permissions**, and counts only the ones ServiceNow allows through.

This matters because it means **COMMAND does not have its own security rules that could disagree with yours**. It follows the access rules already configured in your ServiceNow instance. If your instance restricts records by region, company, or department, COMMAND applies those same restrictions, because it is asking ServiceNow the same question your record lists ask.

### What we tested, and the results

We tested on 30 August using two real accounts on your instance. Neither was an admin.

| Table          | Total records in the table | Account with "itil" role sees | Account with no role sees |
|----------------|----------------------------|-------------------------------|---------------------------|
| incident       | 4,266                      | 4,266                         | 755 to 815                |
| task           | 8,200                      | about 1,337                   | 132                       |
| problem        | 544                        | 544                           | <b>0 — blocked</b>        |
| change_request | 1,505                      | 1,505                         | <b>0 — blocked</b>        |
| kb_knowledge   | 757                        | about 437                     | about 435                 |

The important line is **incident**. ServiceNow's own raw count for that table is 4,266. A user with no roles can genuinely open only about 800 of them. **COMMAND shows that user roughly 800, not 4,266**. A reporting tool that simply counted rows would have shown 4,266 to a person who cannot open most of them.

We also checked the three separate places access has to be enforced, using the "problem" table and the account blocked from it. All three passed:

- **Opening the saved report directly:** blocked, with a clear message. No data shown.
- **Opening the table directly, bypassing the report:** shows 0 records with a plain explanation. Not an error, and not a wrong number.
- **The report list page:** that report is not listed for that user at all.

**What we have NOT tested — please read this**

- **We have not created a region-based rule on your instance and tested against it.** Your development instance does not currently have region or company restrictions configured, and we will not add or change security rules on your instance without your written approval. What we proved is that COMMAND correctly enforces the access rules that *are* present — including rules that block a whole table, and rules that allow only some rows within a table. A region rule is the same kind of rule, applied the same way, so we expect it to behave identically. **But we have not demonstrated it, and we are not going to claim we have.** If you would like this proven before go-live, we can set up a region rule on a test instance and show you.
- **Counts on very large tables can be slightly low.** To keep pages fast, we stop counting after a time limit on big tables and label the number clearly on screen as a lower bound. The number shown may be lower than the true one. **It is never higher.** We designed it this way on purpose: showing fewer records than a user may see is safe, showing more is not.
- **This is not a substitute for a security audit.** We tested COMMAND's behaviour. We did not audit your instance's own access rules, and COMMAND cannot fix a rule that is missing or wrong in ServiceNow itself.

**The honest summary:** COMMAND enforces your existing ServiceNow permissions rather than inventing its own, and we have demonstrated that with real, non-admin accounts on real tables. You can verify every number in this table yourself — the companion walkthrough guide shows you how, step by step.

**8. Design and layout**

Thank you. We noted your feedback and have not changed anything here.

**Extra testing we did this round**

We also ran a full round of testing where we tried to break the product on purpose. We sent bad web addresses, fake table names, fake report IDs, strange search text, and broken settings.

| What we tried                                                    | Result                                 |
|------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------|
| Editing the web address to reach data the user should not see    | Blocked. No data was exposed.          |
| Fake table name, field name, or report ID                        | Clear, simple error message. No crash. |
| Odd search text (quotes, other languages, negative page numbers) | Handled correctly. No error.           |
| The chart labelling problem we fixed last round                  | Checked again. Still fixed.            |
| Our automatic test suite                                         | <b>All 533 checks passed.</b>          |

**Result: we found no new problems.** Everything we fixed in earlier rounds is still working correctly.

**What we need from you**

- **Point 1:** Should a table show only active (open) records by default? Your answer unblocks a small, quick change.
- **Point 7:** Should we build the cache and run a proper production-scale load test next? We recommend doing both before any wide rollout.
- **Security:** Would you like us to set up a region-based access rule on a test instance and demonstrate it to you directly? We can do this whenever you want, but we will not change security settings on your instance without your approval.

